BEWARE:

Misleading Mailings Targeting New Companies.

New business creators often receive deceptive solicitations through the mail that look official. The schemes cite statutory requirements or indicate there are more steps you need to take in order to be compliant in North Carolina as a new company. Most are false.

These solicitations offer to file or retrieve documents for a fee that is usually much higher than the State charges. In some cases, those filings may not even be required. Though the solicitors must indicate they are not a government entity to avoid liability, that language is often buried in very fine print.

Do not be taken advantage of. The NC Secretary of State's Office wants you to be aware of these schemes that target unsuspecting companies before they hit your mailbox.

For Your Information:

1. Once you submit Articles or Registration and receive a certified filed document, no other action is necessary until changes are made to the Articles or Registration or you need to file an Annual Report.
2. Certificates of Existence are ordered online from the Secretary of State's website (www.sosnc.gov) and printed from your computer. The fee for an online Certificate of Existence is $10.00, plus a $3.00 electronic transaction fee. They are ordered for specific reasons, for example, if you are registering in another state to do business. That state will require a Certificate of Existence from North Carolina.
3. Minutes of meetings are taken at the time of the meeting and placed into the business entity records at the principal office location. They do not need to be filed with this office.
4. File Annual Reports online directly with the NC Secretary of State's Office. You do not need a third party to file the Annual Report, but that is your decision.
5. Two more online resources:
   NC SOS Alerts & ABC11.com Misleading Mailing Segment